Ch15 edit, section 2 of 5: What she's carrying

Section 1 is in, as you approved it (“1 yes, 2 yes, 3 four lines”).

One count note. The new lines in section 1 are in your voice (“I”, “she”), so the chapter now has slightly fewer “you” words than the house minimum (39.2 per 1,000, floor 40). I won’t patch that with filler “your”s. Section 3 can fix it naturally: your thesis question, put to the reader as “are *you* being the best husband *you* can be right now?”

This section stays as it is, except for one line readers keep tripping on (inbox #160, item 1).

> ***What she’s carrying.*** *One kind of zing comes on Saturday mornings, on busy weekends. My wife wakes up with a jam-packed agenda ... “There’s an infinite amount of work*

> *to get done. Just look around. I shouldn't have to tell you what to do." You've probably heard your own version of those lines.*

>

> *I used to take those lines personally. Over time I realized a line like that is more **a verdict on how stressed and overworked she is.***

>

> *When you hear a line like that, you can ask one of two different questions ... (unchanged, as you ruled on 2026-10-25, "Middle")*

The one question

Readers stumble on **"a verdict on how stressed and overworked she is."** "Verdict" makes them think of a judgment *she* is

passing, so it can sound like her verdict on you, which is the opposite of what you mean.

- **A. Keep it.** It's your phrase. - **B.** "...a line like that says more about how stressed and overworked she is." - **C.** "...a line like that is more a sign of how stressed and overworked she is."

My pick is **C**. It keeps your sentence and swaps one word ("sign" is the outline's word, too).

Reply A, B or C.